

Word family: **come / comes / came / come / coming**

Base word: come

Past tense: came

Past participle: come

-ing form: coming

Part of speech: mainly verb (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “That may sound a bit random, but when he speaks, everything **comes alive**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **come** is part of the expression **come alive**.

It does not mean physically moving toward someone. Instead, **come + adjective/state** can mean **become or enter that state**.

So **come alive** means to **become lively, vivid, interesting, active, or seemingly full of life**.

In this passage, Mr. Wong's storytelling makes ordinary subjects suddenly feel vivid and engaging.

繁體中文： **由原本較平淡、靜止或缺乏生氣的狀態，變得生動、鮮活、有活力或令人投入**

中文翻譯：

> “...when he speaks, everything **comes alive**.”

「.....但當他說話的時候，一切都**變得生動鮮活起來**。」

Here:

come alive = 變得生動、鮮活、有生命力或充滿活力

Because this exact construction occurs in the passage, it deserves explicit treatment even though the Golden Manual normally avoids expanding broadly into phrasal or fixed verbal constructions unless needed for the target sentence.

1. **come + toward speaker/reference point (移動) — 來 ; 來到**

This is the basic physical meaning.

Meaning: To move toward the speaker, listener, or another relevant place.

Practice 1

> “Can you **come** over here for a moment?”

「你可以**過來**一下嗎？」

Practice 2

> “She **came** into the room and sat beside me.”

「她**走進** / **來到**房間，坐在我旁邊。」

come = 朝說話者、某個參照人物或指定地點移動

This contrasts strongly with **go**, which normally focuses on movement away from the speaker/reference point.

2. **come** = arrive/reach a place (到達) — 到達；來到

Closely related to physical movement, **come** can emphasize arriving at a destination.

Practice 3

> “What time did you **come** home last night?”

「你昨晚幾點**回到家**？」

Practice 4

> “The train **came** into the station shortly after nine.”

「火車九點後不久**抵達車站**。」

come = 經過移動後到達某個地方或位置

For database counting, I would normally **merge** this with Meaning 1, because both belong to the same broad movement/arrival concept.

3. **come** = happen/arrive in time (事件 / 時期) — 到來；發生

Come can describe an event, season, opportunity, moment, or period arriving.

Practice 5

> “Spring **came** early that year.”

「那一年春天**來得很早**。」

Practice 6

> “The opportunity **came** when she least expected it.”

「這個機會在她最沒有預料的時候**出現 / 到來**。」

come = 某個時間、事件、機會或階段到來或開始出現

The subject itself is not necessarily physically moving.

4. **come + adjective/state (狀態)** — 變得；進入某種狀態

This is the core meaning behind your original sentence.

Meaning: To change from one state into another.

Practice 7 — Original

> “When he speaks, everything **comes alive**.”

「當他說話時，一切都**變得生動鮮活起來**。」

Practice 8

> “The handle **came loose** after years of use.”

「手柄使用多年後**變鬆了**。」

Practice 9

> “Her dream finally **came true**.”

「她的夢想終於**成真了**。」

come + state/adjective = 由原本狀態轉變並進入另一種狀態

Useful examples include:

- * come alive
- * come true
- * come loose
- * come open
- * come clean
- * come unstuck

However, some of these are lexicalized expressions, so they should not automatically become separate meanings of **come**.

The common underlying concept is:

> **change into / enter a state**

5. **come from + source/place/person (來源) — 來自 ; 源自**

Meaning: To originate in a particular place, person, source, cause, or background.

Practice 10

> “This tea **comes from** Taiwan.”

「這種茶**來自**台灣。」

Practice 11

> “Most of the information **came from** interviews.”

「大部分資料都**來自**訪問。」

come from = 起源、來源或出處是某個地方、人物、資料來源或原因

Common:

- * come from a country
- * come from a family
- * come from experience
- * come from research

The underlying concept is **origin/source**.

6. **come to + decision/conclusion/understanding (結果 / 認知) — 達到 ; 形成**

Come can describe reaching a non-physical result, conclusion, agreement, or understanding.

Practice 12

> “We eventually **came to a decision**.”

「我們最後**作出了決定**。」

Practice 13

> “She slowly **came to understand** why he had left.”

「她慢慢**開始明白**他為甚麼離開。」

come to + result/state of understanding = 經過一段過程後達到某個結果、結論或認知狀態

This figuratively extends the physical idea of:

> travelling toward a destination → reaching a mental/result destination

I would keep this as a distinct practical sense because learners encounter it very frequently.

7. **come first/second/last (排名 / 次序) — 得第.....名 ; 排在.....**

Come can indicate a person's or thing's position in a race, competition, ranking, or sequence.

Practice 14

> “She **came first** in the competition.”

「她在比賽中**取得第一名**。」

Practice 15

> “Our team **came second**.”

「我們的隊伍**取得第二名**。」

come + ordinal/ranking = 在比賽、評選或排行中取得某個名次

This is sufficiently distinct from movement to keep separately.

8. **come in + size/colour/version (產品形式) — 有.....款式 / 尺寸 ; 以.....形式提供**

A product, service, or object can **come in** different forms, sizes, colours, etc.

Practice 16

> “The shirt **comes in** three colours.”

「這件恤衫**有三種顏色可選**。」

Practice 17

> “The headphones **come in** two different sizes.”

「這款耳機**有兩種不同尺寸**。」

come in + form/size/colour = 某件產品或事物以某種款式、尺寸、版本或形式存在 / 供應

This is a very common modern construction.

I would treat it as a useful grammatical/fixed construction rather than a wholly independent lexical meaning if the database is counting only core senses.

9. **come with + feature/item (配備 / 包含) — 附有 ; 配有**

Another common product/service construction:

Practice 18

> “The camera **comes with** a carrying case.”

「這部相機**附有**一個攜帶袋。」

Practice 19

> “The apartment **comes with** a parking space.”

「這個單位**附有 / 包括**一個泊車位。」

come with something = 某件產品、服務或安排本身附帶或包括某項東西

Again, highly useful but best treated as a construction rather than an entirely separate core

meaning of bare **come**.

10. **come to mind** / an idea comes to someone (想法 / 記憶) — 浮現 ; 想到

Come can describe an idea, memory, answer, or image entering someone's mind.

Practice 20

> “The answer suddenly **came to me**.”

「答案突然**在我腦中浮現** / 我突然想到了答案。」

Practice 21

> “Nothing **comes to mind** immediately.”

「我一時**想不到甚麼** / 腦中沒有立刻浮現任何東西。」

idea/memory comes to mind = 某個想法、答案或記憶開始在腦中出現

This figuratively uses movement toward the mind.

I would keep **come to mind** primarily as a fixed expression rather than inflate the core count.

Related form: **coming**

Coming can mean approaching or expected in the near future.

Practice 22

> “We’ll discuss that in the **coming weeks**.”

「我們會在**未來幾星期** / 接下來幾星期**討論這件事**。」

Practice 23

> “The **coming year** will be important for the company.”

「**來年** / 未來一年**對公司非常重要**。」

coming + time period = 即將到來、接近現在之後的

Important distinction: **come** vs **go**

This is one of the most important English movement contrasts.

come

movement **toward** the speaker, listener, or reference point:

> “Come here.”

「過來。」

go

movement **away from** the speaker/reference point or toward another destination:

> “Go there.”

「去那邊。」

The exact reference point depends on context, but the directional contrast is central.

Important distinction: **come** vs **arrive**

come

can describe the whole movement toward a reference point.

arrive

focuses specifically on reaching the destination.

> “She came to my house at eight.”

> “She arrived at my house at eight.”

Both can describe arrival, but **come** contains stronger reference-point perspective.

Important distinction: **come** vs **become**

These overlap in state-change constructions.

become

is the general verb meaning:

> change into a new state

> “He became famous.”

come

is possible only in certain established combinations:

> come alive

> come true

> come loose

You cannot freely replace **become** with **come**:

> “He came famous.” ❌

So learners should treat **come + adjective/state** as collocational rather than universally productive.

Important distinction: **come alive vs be alive**

This is especially important for your sentence.

be alive

= already living / already active

> “The plant is alive.”

come alive

= change into a lively, vivid, active, or energetic state

> “The story came alive.”

= 故事變得生動起來。

So:

****be alive = 已經是有生命 / 有活力的狀態****

****come alive = 由較平淡或靜止的狀態變得鮮活****

Important distinction: ****come from vs be from****

They often overlap for geographical origin.

> “I ****come from**** Hong Kong.”

> “I ****am from**** Hong Kong.”

Both can mean:

「我來自香港。」

But ****come from**** has a wider source meaning:

> “The noise comes from upstairs.”

「噪音來自樓上。」

> “Confidence comes from experience.”

「信心源自經驗。」

Family-extension note

The direct morphological family of ****come**** is small:

* ****come****

* ****comes****

* ****came****

* ****coming****

Its learning richness comes primarily from its many semantic and grammatical constructions rather than derivational morphology.

Especially useful constructions include:

* come alive

- * come true
- * come from
- * come to a decision
- * come first/second
- * come in different sizes
- * come with something
- * come to mind

Under the Golden Manual, these should be audited carefully, but closely related constructions should not be falsely split into dozens of independent lexical senses.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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come — physical movement/arrival	朝說話者、參照人物或指定地方移動並到達該處
time/event/opportunity comes	某個時間、事件、機會或階段開始出現或到來
come + adjective/state	從原本的情況轉變並進入另一種狀態
come from + source	起源或來源是某個地方、人物、原因或資料來源
come to + decision/conclusion/understanding	經過一段過程後達到某個結果、結論或認知狀態
come first/second/etc.	在比賽、評選或排名中取得某個名次
come in + form/size/colour	某件產品或事物以指定款式、尺寸、版本或形式存在
/ 供應	
come with + item/feature	某件產品、服務或安排本身附帶或包括某項東西
come to mind	某個想法、答案或記憶開始在腦中浮現
coming + time	即將到來、屬於接下來一段時間的

For your original sentence

> “...when he speaks, everything **comes alive**.”

The exact meaning is:

come = 從原本狀態轉變並進入另一種狀態

More specifically:

come alive = 由較平淡、靜止或沒有生氣的狀態，變得生動、鮮活、有活力或令人投入

So:

> **everything comes alive**

= **一切都變得生動鮮活起來**

For your database, I would count **6** genuinely useful core meanings of *come* itself:

1. **move toward / arrive at a reference point**
2. **a time, event, or opportunity arrives/happens**
3. **enter or become a state — come alive, come true, come loose**
4. **originate from a source — come from**
5. **reach a result, decision, conclusion, or understanding**
6. **achieve a position/ranking — come first, second, etc.**

I would keep **come in**, **come with**, and **come to mind** as important constructions/fixed extensions rather than artificially increasing the core polysemy count.